and technical progress, or the England of the savage penal code and brutal behaviour, of entrenched feudalism and reaction?

For there were two Englands, just as in every country there are these two aspects of national character and civilization. 'The discrepancy in England,' write Edward Thompson, 'between the highest and the ordinary levels of our civilization, has always been



immense; I doubt if there is anything like it in any country with which we should wish to be compared and it is a discrepancy **that** lessens so slowly that it often seems hardly to lessen at all.'*

The two Englands live side by side, influencing each other, and cannot be separated; nor could one of them come to India forgetting completely the other. Yet in every major action one plays the leading role, dominating the other, and it was inevitable that the wrong England should play that role in India and should come in contact with and encourage the wrong India in the process.

The independence of the United States of America is more or less contemporaneous with the loss of freedom by India. Surveying the past century and a half, an Indian looks somewhat wistfully